

## Chapter 4: The Vedic Civilization

Textbook Exercise Solutions & Answers



### 1. Name the following with reference to the lesson:

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**Q1.) Women scholars in Vedic literature:**

Lopamudra, Gargi, and Maitreyi.

**Q2.) Means of entertainment in the Vedic period:**

Singing, playing musical instruments, dance, board games, chariot racing, and hunting.

**Q3.) The four ashrams:**

Brahmacharyashrama, Grihasthashrama, Vanaprasthashrama, and Sanyasashrama.

### 2. Right or wrong?

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**Q1.) Rigveda – Mantras uttered during yajna.**

**Wrong** (Mantras uttered during yajna are compiled in the Yajurveda; Rigveda consists of suktas in praise of deities).

**Q2.) Samaveda – Guidance on singing a mantra during yajna rites.**

Right

**Q3.) Atharvaveda – The Veda derived its name from Atharva rishi.**

Right

### 3. Answer in one word each:

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**Q1.) The language of Vedic literature:**

Sanskrit.

**Q2.) The meaning of vid:**

To know.

**Q3.) The head of a family:**

Grihapati.

**Q4.) The head of shrenis:**

Shreshthi.

**4. Name the following:**

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**Q1.) The musical instruments you know:**

Veena, flute, mridangam, tabla, guitar, violin.

**Q2.) Two modern ornaments of women:**

Earrings, necklaces, and bangles.

**Q3.) Today's means of entertainment:**

Television, cinema, reading, sports, and digital games.

**5. Answer in short:**

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**Q1.) What foods were included in the diet of the Vedic people?**

1. The staple diet of the Vedic people mainly consisted of cereals like wheat, barley, and rice. From these, they prepared various dishes like *yava* (barley preparations), *godhooma* (wheat), and *vrihi* (rice).
2. They also consumed milk, yoghurt, ghee, butter, honey, lentils, black gram, sesame, and meat.

**Q2.) Why were the cows priced highly?**

1. In Vedic society, cows were considered a symbol of wealth and were used as a primary medium of exchange.
2. Consequently, cows were valued very highly, and families took utmost care to protect them from being stolen.

**Q3.) What was a man expected to do in sanyasashrama?**

The fourth stage of life was *Sanyasashrama*. In this stage, a person was expected to renounce all worldly relations and possessions, contemplate the true meaning of human existence, and avoid settling permanently in any one place.

## 6. Write notes on:

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### Q1.) The religious ideas during the Vedic period.

1. In the Vedic religion, natural forces such as the sun, wind, rain, lightning, storms, and sacred rivers were revered and personified as deities.
2. To appease these deities, the Vedic people performed *yajnas*, offering oblations (*havi*) into the sacred sacrificial fire accompanied by Vedic chants.

### Q2.) Houses in the Vedic period.

Houses in the Vedic period were predominantly built using earth, wattle, and daub. Wattle refers to a woven lattice of wooden strips, which was then daubed with clay mixed with cow dung. These residential dwellings were referred to as *griha* or *shala*.

### Q3.) Political system in the Vedic period.

1. The primary duties of the king (*Rajan*) were to safeguard his subjects, collect taxes (*bhaga*), and maintain effective administration.
2. To aid in governance, the king appointed key officials such as the *Purohita* (chief priest), *Senapati* (commander of the army), and *Bhagdugh* (tax collector).
3. The king's authority was guided by four key consultative bodies: the **Sabha**, **Samiti**, **Vidatha**, and **Jana**.